

Werner Schulz Fellowship

Scholarship Briefing & Software Project Strategic Alignment Guide

 **Deadline:** 31 July 2026 |  **Location:** Berlin, Germany |  **Fellowship Period:** Sept – Dec 2026

1. WHO CAN APPLY?

Eligible Applicants:

- Students, trainees, or doctoral candidates from a European country.
- Professionals working in:
 - Civil society & Education
 - Culture & Media
 - Politics & Research

Required Background & Values:

- Proven skills/qualifications in their field.
- Social or political engagement aligned with Werner Schulz's core values:
Democracy • Human Rights • Civil Society • European Cooperation

2. FUNDING & KEY DETAILS

Duration:	Up to 3 months
Grant Amount:	€2,000 / month
Location:	Berlin, Germany
Cohort Size:	Max 2 candidates selected
Period:	Sept – Dec 2026
Application Deadline:	31 July 2026

3. Required Documents

- **Motivation Letter:** Max 2 pages
- **CV:** Max 3 pages
- **Project Concept / Idea:** Max 3 pages
- **Proof of Status:** Student or employment proof
- **Optional:** Reference letters

4. WHAT KIND OF PROJECT DO THEY WANT?

This is the most critical criteria for evaluation. They are looking for action-oriented, high-impact concepts rather than traditional academic work.

Project Requirements:

- Applicants must have their **own project idea** or an **existing project** they are actively developing.
- The project goal must be clearly defined and executable.
- Must demonstrate clear social or democratic impact.

Core Focus Areas:

- Democracy promotion & Rule of Law
- Human rights & Social impact
- Understanding history / Dictatorships
- European cooperation & integration

 **Exclusion Criteria:** Standard commercial software business proposals (e.g., agency client work) and University thesis projects are **strictly NOT accepted**.

Strategic Analysis & Application Orientation

Standard client agency work (*"building websites and custom software for clients"*) will **not** qualify for this fellowship. However, your software engineering background represents a major competitive advantage if channeled through a **social tech / civic technology framework**.

By combining technical execution capability with a clear democratic mission, you can position your software skills to solve real civil society challenges.

Tailored Software Project Proposals Aligned with Werner Schulz Values

Idea 1: Digital Platform for Afghan & Migrant Students in Europe

CIVIC TECH • EDUCATION • INTEGRATION

Concept & Objective: A centralized digital platform designed to support Afghan and migrant youth navigating European higher education systems, legal rights, and social integration.

Key Technical Components:

- Multilingual AI guidance chatbot providing contextual support on rights, visa rules, and university systems.
- Interactive resource directory mapping integration programs, legal assistance, and mentorship opportunities across European cities.

Value Alignment: Human rights, social inclusion, and European cooperation.

Idea 2: Interactive Democracy & Human Rights Learning Hub

EDTECH • CIVIC ENGAGEMENT • EUROPEAN VALUES

Concept & Objective: An engaging web application aimed at educating youth and young adults on democratic principles, human rights frameworks, and historical authoritarianism.

Key Technical Components:

- Interactive visual modules on democratic decision-making, history of dictatorships, and rule of law.
- Gamified scenarios allowing users to explore historical case studies and modern civic dilemmas.

Value Alignment: Democracy promotion, understanding history, and political education.

Idea 3: AI-Powered Media Literacy & Misinformation Detector

AI / NLP • MEDIA FREEDOM • INFORMATION INTEGRITY

Concept & Objective: A web tool/browser extension that helps students and young citizens detect manipulation, fake news, and propaganda in online news and social media.

Key Technical Components:

- AI-assisted claim checking and source credibility analysis for news articles.
- Educational tooltips explaining propaganda techniques and logical fallacies.

Value Alignment: Freedom of media, protecting democratic discourse, and critical thinking.

Idea 4: Digital Storytelling & Historical Memory Archive

DIGITAL ARCHIVE • CULTURAL MEMORY • EUROPEAN SOLIDARITY

Concept & Objective: An open digital platform collecting, preserving, and sharing personal stories from refugees, migrants, and young Europeans experiencing societal transitions.

Key Technical Components:

- Secure, user-friendly portal for collecting oral histories, written testimonies, and media.
- Interactive storytelling map connecting human stories across European geographic boundaries.

Value Alignment: Understanding history, human rights, and fostering cross-cultural European solidarity.